

LIVING SAVIOR NEWSLETTER



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PASTOR ANDY'S MESSAGE

By Pastor Andy Lissy

Ancient mythology tells the story of the phoenix, a magnificent bird, plumed in purples, golds, reds, and blues. According to the myth, the phoenix lived for 500 years, and at its life's end would build a nest high in the trees and line it with richly scented spices and herbs. There the phoenix rested until the sun ignited the nest, and the fire consumed both nest and bird. The miracle came when a new phoenix would rise from the ashes of its predecessor, new life springing from the sacrifice of the old.



As we enter the Lenten season it is good to remember that our Christian faith is an even greater story; the story of the resurrection of Jesus from the dead. Jesus was crucified, died and was buried. But on the third day he rose again from the grave and because he rose we have the hope of the resurrection. God has promised us that even though we die we will rise again to live in his kingdom forever. This story is greater than the story of the phoenix because it is not just a myth, the story of Jesus' resurrection is true.

We know that we need to repent of our sins and begin to live in a new way. We long to be forgiven for those sins and reconciled with those we have wronged. But sometimes we find it hard to believe that God or anyone else would forgive us because we find it so hard to forgive ourselves. Still, we desire forgiveness.

Over and over again in the scriptures we see God forgiving his people. He is constantly creating a new future for them. While they often suffer the consequences of their actions, God never abandons them. God never declares an end to their relationship.

Like the phoenix we are able to rise from the ashes of our sin and live as forgiven people. We are able to escape from our graves of hatred and bitterness and live as forgiving people. We are able to die to our feelings of anger and our desire for revenge and rise to live as God's people. We can do that because of the power of the Holy Spirit who will help us and uphold us and give us the strength and courage we need.

May our Lord fill you with that mercy and grace this Lenten Season,

Pastor Andrew C. Lissy

President's Message

We are preparing for the next year of the Board or Servant Leaders and Ministry Leads that take over August 1, 2022.

Henni Froemke, Paul Hancq, Ric Weyrick, Paul Gross, and John Hollander have volunteered to serve on the Nominating Committee, chaired by Deb Malone, to nominate candidates to fill BOSL and ministry lead vacancies for the upcoming period of 1 Aug 22-31 Jul 24. Any member can nominate candidates for consideration. The congregation will vote on the nominees at the Annual Voter's assembly this summer. Vacancies are as follows:

BOSL

- President
- Vice President
- Secretary
- Treasurer
- At-Large Member

Ministry Leads

- Property
- Stewardship

Other

- Volunteer to lead the Vicar change-over this summer

Please contact Deb Malone at 703-850-1274 or hmalone65@outlook.com if you are interested in serving in any of these positions or would like to nominate someone.





Stewardship Message

Did you make New Year's resolutions and how are you doing? If you recall, in the January stewardship note I reflected on how all of us may want to resolve to consider our own Christian life and look for ways to grow and contribute to the church. After I submitted the Stewardship Note, I received in the mail an excerpt of "The Old Farmer's Almanac". The Almanac talked about the differences in resolutions from 1947 and today as reported in a Gallup Poll. Many of the top ten resolutions have the same thought but may have been worded a little bit differently. However, two 1947 resolutions struck me as different from today in the top ten – 1) Improve my disposition, be more understanding, control my temper and 2) Be more religious, go to church more often. Personally, I like those thoughts. Since we are in the season of Lent, which many feel is a time for reflection, now may be a good time to reflect on what God has done for us and our response to God's love for us.

From a financial perspective the income and expenses are:

Total income for February 2022 was \$43,603. Total expenses for February 2022 was \$46,321, leaving a net loss for the month of \$2,718.

Year-to-date for August 2021 – February 2022, LSLC's total income is \$392,814 which includes an anonymous gift of \$50,000. Total expenses for August 2021 – February 2022 is \$354,332. With the anonymous gift, we currently have a net income for the fiscal year of \$38,483.

The 2022-2023 budget process will begin on April 4 and April 5 with meetings with the Ministry Leads.

Music and Worship: "OUR LENTEN HYMNODY"



One of the strengths of Lutheran hymnody is the fact that a large number of our hymns are written from a doctrinal (catechetical) perspective and reflect what we believe and confess. We sing what we teach. To be sure, there are a number of meaningful and powerful texts that express praise and our response (subjective) to God's plan for us. "Praise to the Lord, the Almighty," and "Joyful, Joyful, We Adore Thee" would be a couple of examples that come to mind.

My favorite Lenten hymn is "Stricken, Smitten, and Afflicted" LSB # 451. The strength of the text combined with the powerful chorale tune, presents a vivid picture of what Jesus experienced on the cross for us. It portrays a Biblical narrative of the price that our Lord paid and the suffering He endured. The hymn concludes, however, with this wonderful assurance in verse 4:

Here we have a firm foundation, here the refuge of the lost;
Christ, the Rock of our salvation, is the name of which we boast;
Lamb of God, for sinners wounded, sacrifice to cancel guilt!
None shall ever be confounded Who on Him their hope have built.

I encourage you to take the time and study some of the hymnic texts in our hymnal. They are a wonderful encouragement to us in our Lenten journey.

DID YOU KNOW?

Did you know that we have 16 acolytes and crucifers of all ages who currently serve Living Savior in this important ministry. Starting with those in confirmation class, though high school, and on to adults, we are blessed with willing and faithful individuals. Thank you to all of them!

LAY READERS

If you are not currently serving as a Lay Reader and would like to become involved in this important ministry, please contact me.

God bless all of you and your Lenten journey.

Dr. Wallace Horton,
Minister of Worship & Music

Bible Studies /Sunday School / Groups



We welcome all school age children to a fun-filled time learning about Jesus. The unit this fall focuses on Jesus' birth, growing up, and many of his miracles. Primary class is for PreK-Grade 1. Upper elementary is for Grades 2-5. We will meet between services from 10:00 to 10:45 in the Preschool wing. Please email Jean-Marie Galing to register your children.



New Adult Sunday School Series Began March 6th at 9:45 AM

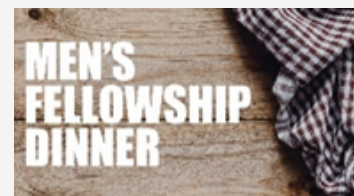
Psalms 8 reads, "What is man, that thou art mindful of him?". Who are we? Are we truly created in the image of God? What does it mean for us to be in a fallen state? What exactly is original sin? What is the "sin nature"? Do we have free will? Do we have the ability to stop sinning? How exactly does the Jesus's work on the cross impact our sinful nature? Join me for an engaging discussion on the "Doctrine of Man" in our Adult Sunday School class. This will be a 5 week series facilitated by Jason Tolbert starting on Sunday, March 6th starting at 9:45 AM in Klein Hall, in between the services.

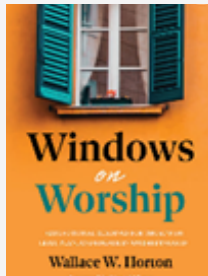
If you have any questions, please feel free to contact Jason Tolbert at jasontolbert@gmail.com



**Confirmation Class, Between Services Sundays (starting after Labor Day).
Contact: Pastor Andy or Vicar Scot**

Men's Christian Fellowship Dinner – 4th Thursday of the Month, at 6 pm in Klein Hall





Living Savior Men's Fellowship Study, Breakfast at 7:30am and study 8am – 9:30am, 2nd and 4th Saturdays. The new study series starting in November will be based on the book "Windows on Worship" by Dr Wallace Horton. The Men's Fellowship will provide the books for study. Study also available virtually, contact Paul Gross for Zoom address

Living Savior Men's Fellowship Happy Hour, 1st and 3rd Friday evenings. Contact Paul Gross for Zoom address

Men's Happy Hour
By Zoom

Events at LSLC



Voter's Meeting

Our regularly scheduled Voters' meeting will be
March 27th at 9:30AM in Klein Hall.

VBS !!!

July 18 - 22, 2022



After 2 long years without VBS, Sarah Loesch has volunteered to take on the role of director this year. We are so very grateful and excited to have this opportunity for all the children. There are many opportunities to help. Specific needs already identified are:

- Promotion Manager
- Registration Manager
- Volunteer Coordinator
- Set up / Clean up Manager
- Teachers
- Group Leaders
- Craft / Food / Bible Story Leader

Please contact Sarah Loesch if you can help this summer.



Easter Egg Hunt

Easter Sunday, April 17th

After 8:30am service/Before 11:00am service

The youth group will once again be hosting an Easter Egg hunt out in the playground / backyard area. Kids bring your Easter Egg baskets.

Donations of small candies and plastic Easter Eggs would be appreciated by the youth group.



Social Ministry

We want to thank LSLC congregants responded Generously to all of our appeals in recent months! With some relaxation of lockdowns and other social distancing and public health directives for COVID-19, we reached out to our partners at Shelter House/NOVACO, FACETS, and Concordia to learn what they needed most in the new “normal.”

- **Artemis House/NOVACO:**

Preventing Idle Hands.... An Ad Hoc Project being initiated with Jerome at Artemis House... how to keep kids busy and engaged in healthy activities. We want to encourage outdoor activities when the weather improves. In the meantime, indoor COVID aware activities are being planned that will enhance school objectives (in disguise). We are also working with the Domestic Violence shelter folks at Bethany House.

- **Shelter House** is opening a new facility in Loudoun County and we are looking for ways to be a force multiplier there.
- **Concordia Food Ministry:** LSLC continues to support Pastor John & his team financially and with food donations. More than \$1,700 in financial donations and hundreds of pounds of food have recently gone to Concordia. Special thanks to Betty Cook who makes sure the food, coats and LSLC checks get to Concordia.
- **FACETS:** Hypothermia Shelters were housed in combined church facilities instead of churches due to COVID. We supported Lord of Life Lutheran in supplying meals to the shelter in February. Financial assistance was used to buy the single serve products that were needed due to COVID precautions. Bridgeway joined in our efforts.
- **Support for Military Members:** \$800 donation to American Legion Post 2003 for Soldiers Angel in support of hospitalized and recovering service members in Germany. By contributing through the Legion, LSLC was able to take advantage of a matching fund challenge.
- **Refugee Support:** Afghanresettlement support (LIRS) and Ukrainian refugee support through LCMS/SED. If you would like to make a monetary contribution, you can send it to LSLC (marked refugee support) or donate directly to LIRS. For more information see https://lirsconnect.org/get_involved/action_center/siv
- **Moving in / Moving out Kits** – Please donate new home basics for those transitioning in/out of Domestic Violence Shelter House (collecting items quarterly). Drop off items at the LSLC. Contact Miki Kolton



Social Ministry

Thank you, Living Savior & Bridgeway, for sharing your time & food!!! We were able to help FACETS feed 60 folks' dinner, 45 breakfast & provide 40 folks with lunches Feb 15-16. The hypothermia shelter is providing food and a warm place for the homeless to sleep (the week of Feb 14, temperatures were in the low 20s at night). Again, Living Savior Social Ministry thanks you for sharing your time & treasures!



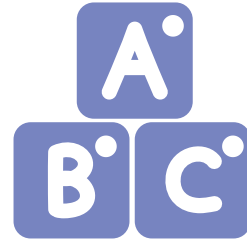
Outreach

- **What's happening sheet** – If you want to see what is happening in February/March/April go to the LSLC website under Announcements to download the LSLC Outreach Information Sheet. Good to pass on to neighbors, family or friends who may be looking to get involved in the LSLC activities.
- **Greeters** – If you are interested in becoming a greeter at services, please contact Ric Weyrick or Bob Willuweit

Opportunities to Serve

- **USHERS!!! We NEED USHERS** – Since many of the congregation are safe-at-home, we need those who can to help as Ushers. For Sunday 8:30 or 11am service Ushers, see Pastor Andy since he will be looking for volunteers for the upcoming months soon.
- **Altar Guild** - Please consider helping with altar guild duties. Teams are on a rotating schedule. Within each team, member decide how they will execute the month's responsibilities so that the schedule is convenient. Free training! Flexible schedule! Many hands make light work! If you would like additional information, please contact Pam Belch: pcbelch@comcast.net
- **Lay Crucifiers** - we have returned to using lay crucifiers at both in-person worship services. All lay people (men and women) middle-school age and older are welcome to service as crucifiers. All must complete a short training prior to serving. To volunteer / schedule your training session. Please contact Dr. Horton
- **Chancel Choir** - The Chancel Choir resumed rehearsals on Wednesdays, 7:30pm in the sanctuary. Membership is open to singers high school age or older. The ability to read music is helpful but not required. If you are interested in being a member, please contact Dr. Horton.
- **Modern Worship Ensemble** - The Modern Worship Ensemble rehearse Tuesdays at 7:30 . If you are interested in participating, please contact Candie Jefferson
- **Lay Readers** - If you are a trained Lay Reader and would like to read in the upcoming months, please see Dr. Horton to select a date(s) to read. If you have not received training to be a Lay reader but would like to become a Lay Reader, please see Dr. Horton so that you can receive training.
- **Live Streaming operators** - Help get the digital message out to those watching live steam worship. We are especially encouraging teens who have digital skills. Contact Pastor Andy

Living Savior Preschool



We are excited to have guests for our “Special Person Tea” later this month hosted and planned by the students in each class to honor, serve and show gratitude towards people in our lives who care for us. We have a few special guests coming: Miss Sandy is bringing some animals for us to see in person, Miss Krista is coming to teach us some ballet/jazz moves, and of course we always enjoy weekly Chapel on Wednesdays and our monthly movement class with Miss Jill. Please call the office if you would like to tour our school at 703 352-4208.

Registration for 2022-2023

Registration for the next school year has begun. LSP offers a warm, Christian learning environment for young children. We are licensed by the state of Virginia and are accredited by the National Association for the Education of Young Children (NAEYC). We believe that LSP offers young children one of the best opportunities to achieve the goals of a Christian education outside of the home as they grow and develop physically, socially, emotionally and intellectually.

LSP enrolls children from 2 ½ through 5 years of age. We offer three-, four- and five-day classes. If you or your friends and neighbors have preschool-aged children, please call the office at (703) 352-4208 or stop by for a brochure or tour of the preschool. Thank you!

Opportunities to Worship

- Sundays 8:30am, **Traditional Worship**, Holy Communion 1st and 3rd Sundays
- Sundays 11:00am, Traditional Worship when not Modern Worship, Holy Communion 2nd and 4th Sundays, **Modern Worship Services** – selected March 27, April 24, May 22 and June 26
- Upcoming Special Worship
 - Midweek Lenten Worship 7:00pm, March 9, 16, 23, 30 and April 6
 - Maundy Thursday Service 7:00pm, April 14
 - Good Friday Service 7:00pm, April 15
 - Easter Worship 8:30am and 11:00am, April 17

On-Line Worship Opportunities - Sunday 11:00am service live-streamed and available for later viewing, see LSLC Website for details

<http://www.livingsaviorlutheran.org/>